

Purpose
Tone
Style

Reading
Strategies

The purpose...

- What is the most likely reason the author wrote ...
- ...author probably wrote to...
- Why do you think the author choose...
- How do you think the author would feel about...
- Why do you think the author decided to...
- Why does the author begin (end) the story with...

Persuade

Written Convince You To Change Your Thinking, Spend Money, Support A Cause, Or Offer A Solution To A Problem

Examples

Advertisements

Commercials

Political Speeches

Opinion Editorials

- Movie Or Book Reviews

Inform

- Written to give information or describe something.
- Authors use facts and reasons to get the point across.
- **Examples**
- Textbooks
- News articles
- Informational Brochures
- Encyclopedias
- Schedules, charts, instructions

Entertain

- Written to interest the reader, or appeal to emotions such as pleasure, sadness, anger, or humor.
- **Examples**
- Fiction books and other stories
- Plays and movies
- Comic strips
- Video games
- Sports articles or programs

Practice

Identify the author's purpose for each of the following types of text.

1. A song about a father's joy and love for his new baby girl.
2. A political speech recommending that you support a tax increase.
3. A poster in the hall that encourages students to say no to drugs.
4. A pamphlet in a doctor's office that explains the disease diabetes.
5. A funny essay
6. A news about COVID-19 vaccine
7. An article about the recent fashion trends
8. A passage that provide historical background of a place
9. An article emphasizing a particular point of view

Key Words to describe writer's purpose

To Persuade	To Inform	To Entertain
Influence Encourage Convince Prove Urge Sell Inspire Convert Assure	Understand Show Describe Educate Discuss Explain Teach Give information Illustrate	Tell Share an experience Relate Provide details Create

Identify the author's purpose and explain your choice:

A wave is any movement that carries energy. Some waves carry energy through water. Others carry energy through gases, like air, or solid materials. If you drop a rock into a pool of water, a wave, or ripple of energy, skims across the pool's surface. In the same way, an underwater earthquake can release energy into ocean water. Then it carries a giant wave, or tsunami, across the surface until it hits land. If you hear a clap of thunder, sound waves (or vibrations) have carried the crashing BOOM to your ears. Sound waves speed through the air at about 1,100 feet (335 meters) per second. Light also travels through the air in waves. They travel at more than 186,000 miles (300 million meters) per second. So the light waves from a flash of lightning reach your eyes before that clap of thunder reaches your ears! Electrons travel in waves, too. They move back and forth in a solid wire, sending waves of electricity so you can turn on a light during the storm!

Author's Tone

- **Tone** indicates the writer's attitude.
- Often described by adjectives, such as: **cynical, depressed, sympathetic, cheerful, outraged, positive, angry, sarcastic, prayerful, ironic, solemn, vindictive, intense, excited.**
- Tone is not an action. It is an attitude.

PRACTICE: Try saying, “**come here, Saad**” using the following tones:

- Commanding or bossy
- Secretive
- Loving
- Angry
- Excited
- Playful

Tone is not explained or expressed directly

- A reader must “read between the lines” to feel the authors attitude and identify the tone.
- Tone is different than “mood.”
- Tone is the **author’s** own attitude toward the subject
- Mood is the emotion the author wants the **readers** to feel while reading about the subject.
- An authors’ tone influences the story's’ mood and atmosphere.

Example

- An author writes a horror story using a **serious** and **sinister** tone.
- That tone helps create a **scary** atmosphere and a **nervous, frightened** mood for the readers.

Examples

“The girl remembered little from the raid at okeadan in which she had been captured. She knew her parents had been killed. She had no idea what had happened to her brothers and sisters. Much of what she had experienced had been so horrible that she had simply shut it out of her mind. . . .”

At Her Majesty's Request p. 17

Serious / solemn

This author's serious **tone** inspires an atmosphere of tragedy. This leads to a **mood** of sadness, sympathy, and caring in the reader when reading this passage.

Examples

“When he realized he was still in one piece, he knew that at the very least he must be completely flat, with his face peering out of his own bottom and his brains leaking out of his ears. . . .”

Toad Heaven p. 64

Humorous

This author’s humorous tone inspires a comic atmosphere. This leads to a playful mood in the reader. (It also helps the reader identify with and care about the characters.)

“By nightfall on Monday, the center of the storm had barely moved, and icy winds of hurricane force swept across an area from Virginia up to nova scotia, Canada. The wind was so powerful that in liberty, New York, the local train station had its roof entirely ripped off
”
...

Blizzard p . 56

Objective / impersonal

- This author’ s impersonal **tone** inspires a serious atmosphere, typical of nonfiction (such as news reports). The **mood** for this piece might be considered studious or academic

Examples

“ . . . the next minute, Winn-Dixie looked like a furry bullet, shooting across the building, chasing that mouse. He was barking and his feet were skidding all over the polished pick-it-quick floor, and people were clapping and hollering and pointing. They really went wild when Winn-Dixie actually caught the mouse.”

Because of Winn-Dixie p. 36

Enthusiastic

- This author's enthusiastic tone inspires an active, lively atmosphere. The author hopes to influence the readers to be in an excited mood, anticipating more action.

Examples of Tone Words

- Cautious
- Humorous
- Affectionate
- Hostile
- Critical
- Objective
- Personal
- Violent
- Solemn / serious
- Sarcastic
- Disapproving
- Enthusiastic
- Desperate
- Pleading
- Indifferent

Style of the writer:

1. Formal
(sophisticated)

2. Informal
(casual)

- The tone in **formal language**, words choice and the way the words are put together vary between the two styles.
- less personal than informal language.
- used in writing for professional or academic purposes.
- does not use colloquialisms, contractions or first person pronouns
- **Informal language** is casual and spontaneous.
- used when communicating with friends or family in writing or in conversation.
- used when writing personal emails and text messages
- tone of informal language is more personal than formal language.

Style of the Writer

Author's style is the way he/she uses words to make ideas come alive on the page.

- Style techniques:
 - **Word choice**
 - **Sentence arrangement**
 - **Sentence structure**
- all work together to establish the meaning in the text influencing how we interpret the information presented.

Consider the following sentences:

1. He's passed away.
2. He's sleeping with the fishes.
3. He died.
4. He's gone to meet his maker.
5. He kicked the bucket.

The version of that sentence that a writer chooses tells us about the situation, the speaker, and the person being spoken to (the audience).

Formal vs. Informal Writing

1. Contractions

- I: The improvements **can't** be introduced due to funding restrictions.
- F: Improvements cannot be introduced due to funding restrictions.
- I: I **don't** believe that the results are accurate.
- F: The results are not believed to be accurate.

2. Phrasal verbs

- I: The balloon was **blown up** for the experiment.
- F: The balloon was **inflated** for the experiment.
- I: The patient **got over** his illness.
- F: The patient **recovered** from his illness.

3. Slang/Colloquialism

- I: It was raining **cats and dogs**.
- F: It was raining **very heavily**.
- I: Lecturers still **count on** students to use correct grammar and punctuation in essays.
- F: Lecturers **expect** students to use correct grammar and punctuation in essays.

Formal vs. Informal Writing

4. First person pronouns

- I: I considered various research methods for the study.
- F: Various research methods were considered for the study.
- I: We believe the practice is unsustainable.
- F: It is believed the practice is unsustainable.

5. Acronyms

- TAFE Technical and Further Education
- ANZAC Australian and New Zealand Army Corps
- QANTAS Queensland and Northern Territory Aerial Services

6. Initialisms

- UTS University of Technology Sydney
- ISO International Standards Organization
- OECD Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development

Examples

Formal Writing Style The tone is polite, but impersonal

Informal Writing Style The tone is more personal

- Formal
 - To Whom it May Concern,
 - Many people enjoy amusement parks.
 - Studies show many people spend too much time on the computer.
- Informal
 - Dear Grandma,
 - You like amusement parks, right?
 - Do you spend too much time on the computer like many people do?

Formal vs. Informal Writing

- Formal Writing Style Avoids using contractions and slang
- Informal Writing Style Freely uses contractions and slang

Examples:

Formal

- **It is** important to do homework.
- Going to an amusement park was a **thrilling** experience.
- It **does not** take a genius to **figure this out**.

Informal

- **It's** important to do homework.
- Going to an amusement park was **cool!**
- It **doesn't** take a genius to **get this**.

Formal vs. Informal Writing

- Formal Writing Style Maintains a serious tone
- Informal Writing Style May use humor or more casual tone
- Examples:

Formal

- Thank you for sending the package. It was a thoughtful thing to do.
- A person should want others to take time to read what they write.

Informal

- Thanks for the package. It was thoughtful of you.
- Who would be crazy enough to write something that nobody reads?

When analyzing style, you must look at a piece of writing **FROM** the overall structure of the text **TO** the small details and word choices. Be an editor, a critic, to answer the question: How would I describe this author's writing style?

Donovan and Larry were early for baseball practice. They decided to run up and down the bleachers to exercise before the rest of the team arrived. Larry was first to the top. He whispered to Donovan, "look over there." He pointed to a man sleeping on the highest, narrow bench of the bleachers. His pants and shirt were faded, worn, and too large for his thin frame. One big toe stuck out of a huge hole in his sock. His scraped-up shoes sat a few feet away. Donovan whispered, "we should help him out. Let's hide something good in his shoes. Then, when he wakes up, he will have a nice surprise."

Assigned Reading

- **Essay from Model for Writers**

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